

Strategic Deployment and Commercialisation Plan

AI Career LaunchPad

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Project: AI Career LaunchPad

Builder: Marco Martins

Context: Ironhack AI Consulting & Integration Bootcamp — Final Capstone Project

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1. Deployment Phases

Phase 0 — POC (Complete)

Status: Done. WF1 Career Compass and WF3 Application Engine are working end to end. One live user (the builder). Ironhack cohort colleagues engaged as first beta testers.

What was proved: The pipeline works. PDF extraction, parallel LLM extraction, profile matching with programmatic validation, and HTML report generation all function as designed. Output quality is sufficient to generate genuine career positioning insight. The system is worth building further.

Phase 1 — Dual-Track: Job Search + MVP Build (Months 1–3)

Dates: Immediately post-bootcamp — approximately May to July 2026.

This phase is honest about its constraints. The builder is simultaneously conducting an active job search and building the MVP. LaunchPad is not paused during the job search — it runs as a live tool on the builder's own transition, generating real outputs that are used in real applications. This is the most credible possible validation: the product's first serious user is the person who built it, using it under the exact conditions it was designed for.

Objectives:

- *Complete MVP Sprint 1: authentication layer, transparency notices at form trigger, consent mechanism, basic audit logging*
- *Complete MVP Sprint 2: data persistence (Supabase EU), satisfaction scoring, DPA templates for operators and coaches, security review*
- *Run LaunchPad on own job search — generate Career Compass and at least 5 Application Engine reports against real job descriptions*
- *Collect structured feedback from Ironhack cohort beta testers (minimum 10 users)*
- *Refine prompts and output quality based on real-world usage*

Milestone: End of month 3 — MVP V1.0 is live, legally compliant for UC2, and has been used by at least 10 people with documented satisfaction scores.

Phase 2 — Pilot (Months 4–6)

Focus: Individual coaching clients. B2C before B2B.

Individual coaching clients are the right first market. The sales cycle is shorter, feedback is richer, the relationship is direct, and every client who goes through the 8-week programme becomes a proof point for the operator conversation. Two clients per month at €800 per programme generates €4,800 over the pilot period — enough to validate the pricing model and cover ongoing costs.

Objectives:

- *Onboard first 6 individual coaching clients through the full 8-week career transition programme with LaunchPad integrated*
- *Collect satisfaction scores, profile match accuracy ratings, and outcome data (interviews secured, roles targeted)*
- *Document 2–3 client case studies with concrete outcomes*
- *Initiate first conversation with Ironhack about a pilot cohort — armed with beta tester feedback and early client outcomes*
- *Begin outreach to 2 additional bootcamp operators beyond Ironhack*

Milestone: End of month 6 — 6 clients completed, satisfaction score $\geq 80\%$ at 4–5 out of 5, at least 1 operator conversation in progress, first case study published.

Phase 3 — Full Deployment (Months 7–12)

Focus: First operator licence signed. Coaching practice at capacity. Coach licensing model documented but not yet actively sold.

Objectives:

- *Sign first bootcamp operator licence (target: Ironhack or equivalent). Deliver first cohort (15–20 participants) with facilitated Career Compass debrief session*
- *Scale individual coaching practice to consistent 2 clients/month*
- *Publish pricing, DPA templates, and onboarding materials for coach licensing (UC3) — make it available but do not actively sell until operator model is validated*
- *Collect operator cohort satisfaction data and placement outcomes*
- *Refine MVP based on operator cohort learnings*

Milestone: End of month 12 — 1 operator licence active, 18+ individual clients completed, €35,000+ revenue generated across all streams, coach licensing infrastructure ready but not yet sold.

Phase 4 — Scale (Year 2+)

Focus: Expand operator base to 4. Begin active coach licensing outreach. Evaluate product vs service long-term model.

Objectives:

- 4 operators licensed, each running 4 cohorts/year
- 3–8 coaches licensed on SaaS + per-client model
- Coaching practice maintained or transitioned to group programme format to remove capacity constraint
- Evaluate whether to hire an associate coach or technical co-founder
- Assess whether to productise toward self-serve SaaS or maintain service-led model

Note on commercialisation model: The long-term model is service-led. LaunchPad is delivered as part of a human coaching engagement, not as a standalone self-serve product. This is a deliberate choice grounded in the AI Manifesto — human judgement over automated decisions, human enhancement over human replacement. A self-serve product without a human layer risks the over-confidence problem identified in the risk assessment: polished AI output acted on without a coaching conversation to challenge and contextualise it. The service model is not a limitation — it is a differentiator.

2. Timeline

Phase	Period	Key Milestone
<i>Phase 0 — POC</i>	<i>Complete</i>	<i>WF1 and WF3 working end to end</i>
<i>Phase 1 — Dual-track MVP build + job search</i>	<i>Months 1–3 (May–Jul 2026)</i>	<i>MVP V1.0 live, 10+ beta users, legally compliant for UC2</i>
<i>Phase 2 — Pilot (individual coaching)</i>	<i>Months 4–6 (Aug–Oct 2026)</i>	<i>6 clients, ≥80% satisfaction, 1 operator conversation active</i>

Phase	Period	Key Milestone
Phase 3 — Full deployment	Months 7-12 (Nov 2026–Apr 2027)	1 operator licence signed, 18+ clients, €35k+ revenue
Phase 4 — Scale	Year 2+ (May 2027 onward)	4 operators, 3-8 coaches licensed, €84k ARR target

3. Go-to-Market Strategy

Target buyers

Primary (Phase 2): Individual professionals making a self-directed career transition into AI consulting. Typically 10-25 years of prior domain experience. Completing or recently completed an AI bootcamp. Feeling the gap between technical skills acquired and credible AI consulting identity. Reachable through the Ironhack alumni network, LinkedIn content, and word of mouth within bootcamp cohorts.

Secondary (Phase 3): Bootcamp operators and corporate L&D providers seeking a structured AI-specific career positioning complement to their existing career services. Decision-maker is typically the Head of Career Services, Programme Director, or Chief Learning Officer. Reachable through direct outreach, bootcamp industry networks, and referrals from individual alumni who experienced the product.

Tertiary (Phase 4, passive): Career transition coaches seeking to elevate their practice with AI-powered pre-session analysis. Not actively sold until operator model is validated. Reachable through coaching professional networks and LinkedIn.

Sales channel

B2C: Direct. The builder is the coach and the product. No intermediary. Clients are sourced through LinkedIn content, Ironhack alumni network, and referrals from satisfied clients. The 8-week programme is sold as a complete engagement — LaunchPad is an integrated tool, not a separate line item.

B2B (operators): Direct outreach by the builder. The sales conversation starts with a demonstrated outcome — beta tester feedback, client satisfaction scores, and where

available, placement data. The first operator is Ironhack, where the relationship already exists. The ask is a free pilot cohort to generate proof before a licence fee is discussed.

B2B2C (coaches): Inbound only in Phase 4. Coaches who experience LaunchPad as clients or hear about it through professional networks enquire directly. A self-serve onboarding flow (DPA sign, payment, form URL access) handles the transaction without requiring a sales call.

Pricing model

Segment	Model	Price
Individual coaching client (UC2)	8-week career transition programme, LaunchPad included	€800 per client
Bootcamp operator (UC1)	Setup + education fee + per-participant cohort fee	€1,000 setup + €75/participant/cohort
Licensed coach (UC3)	Setup + monthly SaaS + per-client fee	€500 setup + €75/month + €25/client

Key differentiator vs existing alternatives

Existing tools — LinkedIn Premium career coaching, generic CV review services, AI CV writers — treat prior experience as a keyword list. They optimise for ATS screening. They do not understand career transitions, working style, or how to reframe 20 years of domain expertise as an AI consulting differentiator.

LaunchPad's differentiator is specificity. The Career Compass output is grounded in the candidate's actual data — their LinkedIn history, their CliftonStrengths profile, their own self-reflection. It produces positioning that could not belong to anyone else. The elevator pitch, the concern response, the gap analysis — all of it is specific to one person. No other tool in the career services market does this for AI consulting transitions specifically.

The secondary differentiator is the human layer. LaunchPad is not a chatbot. It is not a self-serve CV tool. It is an AI-powered instrument used inside a human coaching relationship. That combination — AI precision plus human judgement — is what the market is missing.

4. Stakeholder Communication Plan

Stakeholder 1 — Ironhack (as future operator)

What they need to believe after the Week 9 presentation: "This is worth giving a try — let's run a pilot cohort."

What they need to know:

- *LaunchPad is a complement to CareerHack, not a replacement. It solves the AI-specific positioning gap that general career programmes do not cover.*
- *The POC works. The output is real. They can see it in the live demo.*
- *The ask is low-risk: a free pilot cohort. No upfront licence fee until outcomes are demonstrated.*
- *Student data is handled under a DPA — Ironhack remains the data controller. Their GDPR obligations are unchanged.*

Who communicates: Marco Martins, directly, in the Week 9 presentation and in a follow-up meeting with the relevant programme or career services lead.

When: Week 9 Day 5 presentation is the opening. Follow-up meeting within 2 weeks. Pilot proposal document delivered within 30 days.

Stakeholder 2 — Ironhack Students and Cohort Colleagues (as alpha testers and first users)

What they need to believe after the Week 9 presentation: "I want to enrol as an alpha tester now."

What they need to know:

- *The tool was built for them — for exactly the transition they are navigating right now.*
- *Alpha testers get free access in exchange for structured feedback.*
- *The Career Compass report takes one form submission and returns a personalised positioning report. It is not a long process.*
- *Their data is session-only — nothing is stored.*

Who communicates: Marco Martins, in the presentation and via direct follow-up with cohort colleagues.

When: Week 9 Day 5 — alpha tester sign-up CTA embedded in the presentation and in the Career Compass report itself (Tab 5, Day 1 action). Follow-up within 48 hours with form URL and instructions.

Stakeholder 3 — Individual Coaching Clients (Phase 2 onwards)

What they need to believe before signing up: "This coach understands the specific transition I am making, and this tool will give me something no CV service or LinkedIn Premium subscription can."

What they need to know:

- *The 8-week programme is structured around their transition, not a generic career coaching framework.*
- *LaunchPad produces a Career Compass in week 1 that anchors every subsequent coaching conversation.*
- *The output is specific to them — not a template, not a generic report.*
- *Price, format, and what to prepare (LinkedIn PDF, CliftonStrengths report, Self-Reflection Workbook).*

Who communicates: Marco Martins, via LinkedIn content, direct outreach, and a programme landing page (MVP).

When: Ongoing from Phase 2 (month 4). LinkedIn content begins in Phase 1 to build audience before the coaching practice launches.

Stakeholder 4 — Licensed Career Transition Coaches (Phase 4, passive)

Communication approach: Not actively sold in Phases 1-3. The coach licensing model is documented and the infrastructure will be ready by end of Phase 3, but outreach does not begin until the operator model is validated and at least one case study is available.

When active: Phase 4. Outreach via coaching professional networks and LinkedIn. The product sells itself to coaches who experience it as clients or hear about outcomes from their peers.

5. KPIs per Phase

Phase 1 — Dual-Track MVP Build + Job Search

KPI	Target
<i>MVP V1.0 features complete</i>	<i>Authentication, consent mechanism, transparency notice, audit logging, data persistence</i>
<i>Beta users (Ironhack cohort)</i>	<i>Minimum 10</i>
<i>Beta user satisfaction score</i>	<i>≥ 70% rating output as useful (4-5 out of 5)</i>
<i>Own Career Compass reports generated</i>	<i>Minimum 1 (self)</i>
<i>Own Application Engine reports generated</i>	<i>Minimum 5 against real job descriptions</i>

Phase 2 — Pilot (Individual Coaching)

KPI	Target
<i>Individual coaching clients onboarded</i>	<i>6</i>
<i>Client satisfaction — overall programme</i>	<i>≥ 80% rating 4-5 out of 5</i>

<i>KPI</i>	<i>Target</i>
<i>Client satisfaction — Career Compass accuracy</i>	<i>≥ 75% confirming top profile felt accurate</i>
<i>Operator conversations initiated</i>	<i>Minimum 1 (Ironhack)</i>
<i>Revenue generated</i>	<i>€4,800 (6 clients × €800)</i>

Phase 3 — Full Deployment

<i>KPI</i>	<i>Target</i>
<i>Operator licences signed</i>	<i>1</i>
<i>Operator cohort participants</i>	<i>15–20</i>
<i>Operator cohort satisfaction</i>	<i>≥ 75% rating 4–5 out of 5</i>
<i>Individual coaching clients (cumulative)</i>	<i>18+</i>
<i>Revenue generated (cumulative)</i>	<i>€35,000+</i>

<i>KPI</i>	<i>Target</i>
<i>Coach licensing infrastructure ready</i>	<i>DPA template, onboarding flow, pricing page live</i>

Phase 4 — Scale

<i>KPI</i>	<i>Target</i>
<i>Operator licences active</i>	<i>4</i>
<i>Annual cohort participants across operators</i>	<i>280 (4 × 4 × 17.5)</i>
<i>Licensed coaches active</i>	<i>3–8</i>
<i>Annual recurring revenue</i>	<i>€84,000+ (operator stream alone)</i>
<i>Net Promoter Score — individual clients</i>	<i>≥ 50</i>

6. Commercialisation Model

Model: Service-led, with a productised AI tool at its core.

AI Career LaunchPad is commercialised as a service — not as a standalone SaaS product. This is a deliberate, principled choice, not a concession to the current stage of development.

The reasoning is threefold.

First, the AI output requires a human layer to be used responsibly. A polished Career Compass report delivered without a coaching conversation creates the over-confidence risk identified in the risk assessment and the EU AI Act compliance documentation. The candidate reads the positioning statement, sees an 86% fit score, and applies for roles without the challenge and contextualisation that a human conversation provides. The service model is the human oversight mechanism. It is not a bolt-on — it is architecturally necessary for the product to deliver on its promise.

Second, the service model is how trust is built in a new market. AI career tools are new. Candidates are sceptical. The coaching relationship is the trust layer that makes the AI output credible and actionable. As the market matures and LaunchPad builds a track record, the balance between service and product can shift — but it cannot be shortcut.

Third, the service model is more defensible than a SaaS product in the short term. A SaaS career tool can be copied. A coaching practice built on a proprietary AI tool, with a documented track record of outcomes, with a licensed network of coaches delivering the same methodology — that is a defensible position. The product is the moat. The service is the business.

The long-term vision is a hybrid: a service-led practice for individual clients and operator cohorts, with a coach licensing layer that extends the methodology at scale without requiring the builder's time for every engagement. The SaaS question is revisited at Phase 4, with real outcome data, before any decision is made.